

Problem 6

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Problem 1 A piecewise defined function f is given by

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{2x-3}{x-2} & \text{if } x < 2 \\ \frac{x^2-5x+6}{x^2-4} & \text{if } x > 2 \end{cases}$$

Determine the form of the limit, then find the limit.

(a) $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2^+} f(x)$

Explanation. Since $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2^+} f(x) = \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^+} \frac{x^2-5x+6}{x^2-4}$, the form of the limit is $\frac{0}{0}$.

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^+} f(x) &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^+} \frac{x^2-5x+6}{x^2-4} = \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^+} \frac{(x-3)(x-2)}{(x-2)(x+2)} = \\ \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^+} \frac{x-3}{x+2} &= -\frac{1}{4} \end{aligned}$$

(b) $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2^-} f(x)$

Explanation. Since $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2^-} f(x) = \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^-} \frac{2x-3}{x-2}$, the form of the limit is $\frac{\#}{0}$.

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 2^-} f(x) = \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^-} \frac{2x-3}{x-2} = -\infty,$$

since the numerator positive, the denominator negative and goes to 0.

(c) $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2} f(x)$

Explanation. The limit does not exist, because $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2^+} f(x) \neq \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^-} f(x)$.